

Auxiliary Verbs

Study these examples of modal auxiliary verbs.

I can/could work overtime if you want.	making an offer
May/Can I come in?	asking for permission
Phil can speak Japanese, but he cannot write it. My previous secretary could type quickly, but she could not use spreadsheets.	present ability/inability past ability/inability
Will/Can/Could you help me with this report, please?	making a request
You have not eaten all day? You must be hungry. That is Susan's car. She must have arrived already.	deduction deduction in the past
Mr. Hershaw may/might/could know the answer. I might have left my keys in the car.	possibility possibility in the past
They are charging \$300 an hour. That cannot be right. Julie was away last week so she could not have heard the news.	certainty certainty in the past
You can use this office, but you cannot smoke in here.	permission
I must finish this work today. You must not park in front of the fire escape.	obligation
You should go home if you are not feeling well.	advice
You should not have worked so late last night.	advice in the past
Employees should always arrive on time.	responsibility
You should not have any trouble finding us. We are next to the station.	expectation
My tooth really hurts. I will have to go to the dentist. You do not have to come in to work tomorrow.	necessary not necessary

MINI TEST Auxiliary Verbs

Choose the most appropriate answer: (A), (B), (C), or (D), to complete each sentence.

1. Visitors sit in Row G because those seats are reserved.
(A) could not
(B) cannot
(C) do not have to
(D) might not
2. This project is very important, so we try our best to make it a success.
(A) can
(B) must have
(C) may
(D) have to
3. Excuse me. you open the door for me, please?
(A) Could
(B) Must
(C) May
(D) Should
4. You checked the details more thoroughly before you signed the agreement.
(A) must have
(B) had to have
(C) may have
(D) should have
5. In my last job I have to wear a suit.
(A) must not
(B) should not
(C) did not
(D) could not
6. Donald called as there are no messages on my answer phone.
(A) must be
(B) could not have
(C) had to
(D) should not
7. If you get some professional advice you be able to save the company.
(A) must have
(B) have to
(C) can
(D) might
8. Meeting Room C is the only room that hold sixty people.
(A) should
(B) can
(C) must
(D) has to
9. We try to get to this afternoon's meeting early as we need to set up the projector.
(A) must
(B) would
(C) cannot
(D) need
10. The store had so many computers I not decide which one to buy.
(A) would
(B) could
(C) should
(D) might

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| 1. (A) (B) (C) (D) | 4. (A) (B) (C) (D) | 7. (A) (B) (C) (D) | 10. (A) (B) (C) (D) |
| 2. (A) (B) (C) (D) | 5. (A) (B) (C) (D) | 8. (A) (B) (C) (D) | |
| 3. (A) (B) (C) (D) | 6. (A) (B) (C) (D) | 9. (A) (B) (C) (D) | Score/10 |